

Great Hall Booking Procedure Review

Meeting Information

Date	28 July 2026
Time	14:00 – 15:00
Venue	Microsoft Teams
Purpose	Review of the Great Hall Booking Procedure and Booking Form

Attendance

Present

- Mthuthuzeli Ndlebe
- Mamosadi Makhafula
- Thandazo Ngwevungwevu
- Nkosing'bonele Ntshangase
- Reatlegile Motlhale
- Lerato Malebana
- Zimbini Kaleni

Apologies

- Sergio Lephadi

Agenda

The purpose of the meeting was to review the Great Hall booking form and ensure that all sections were completed correctly in preparation for the planned event.

Opening Remarks

- Mr Nkosing'bonele Ntshangase welcomed everyone to the meeting.
- Mr Mthuthuzeli Ndlebe was welcomed and thanked for making time to guide the team.
- Mr Ndlebe then led the discussion, reviewing the booking form section by section and providing clarification where required.

Discussion Items

1. Event Date and Time

- The proposed event dates of **16–17 September** were discussed.
- Concern was raised that these dates fall during the academic week.
- Potential issues include:
 - High pedestrian traffic due to lectures.
 - Nearby test and examination venues.
 - Limited parking availability during weekdays.
- It was noted that the Disaster Management and Facilities teams are likely to question these dates during the approval process.
- A recommendation was made to consider moving the event to the weekend to reduce these challenges.
- As the event is scheduled for the evening, it was noted that venue setup will most likely occur on the day of the event.
- During setup, the complete audiovisual system should be tested using all presentation content to ensure everything functions correctly before guests arrive.

2. Media and Audio Visual Requirements

- Videography is not provided by the Great Hall or ICT.
- Professional videographers may be privately contracted.
- The appointed media team will also coordinate the live streaming of the event.
- ICT must be contacted to provide microphones.
- The Great Hall provides:
 - Stage lighting
 - Sound system
 - Audio Visual (AV) system
- The organising committee must confirm the number of roving microphones required.

3. Stage and Presentation Arrangements

- The podium contains a digital lectern that allows presentations to be loaded before the event.
- This eliminates the need for speakers to connect their own devices during the programme.
- Mr Ndlebe graciously offered the use of the digital lectern at no additional cost.
- The older presentation system can also be made available if required.
- Presentation loading should form part of the pre-production activities to minimise unnecessary movement on stage.
- It was noted that presenters handling classified or privileged information may prefer alternative arrangements.

4. Guests

- Approximately 80% of attendees are expected to be students.
- The organising committee should provide realistic attendance numbers to assist planning.
- Accurate attendance figures assist with:
 - Security planning
 - Venue management
 - Seating arrangements
 - Operational logistics
- For ministerial or VIP guests, their delegations should also be specified by providing a breakdown of accompanying attendees.

5. Great Hall Fees

Item	Status / Cost
Microphone Fees	To Be Confirmed (dependent on number of roving microphones)
Cleaning Fee	To Be Confirmed (new tariff schedule pending confirmation)
Screen and Projector	R1800 per hour
Additional Hour Usage	R2900 per hour
Ushers	Great Hall will provide ushers. External ushers may also be utilised.

6. Backup Power

- Considering the profile and stature of the event, backup electrical supply should be considered.
- The committee was advised to engage OFMD regarding the use of the standby generator for the duration of the event.

7. Holding Rooms

- Due to the anticipated number and profile of guests, nearby venues should be booked as holding rooms.
- These rooms may be used for speakers, VIP guests and delegations before and after the event.

8. Catering

- Catering arrangements must comply with the University's approved vendor requirements.
- Only approved Wits catering providers may be used.

Action Items

Action	Responsible
Review possibility of moving the event to a weekend	Organising Committee
Confirm number of roving microphones required	Organising Committee
Contact ICT regarding microphone provision	Organising Committee
Arrange audiovisual testing before the event	Organising Committee
Provide accurate guest and delegation numbers	Organising Committee
Confirm updated Great Hall fees	Mr Mthuthuzeli Ndlebe
Consult OFMD regarding generator availability	Organising Committee
Book nearby holding rooms if required	Organising Committee
Confirm approved catering vendors	Organising Committee

Important Reminder

The committee is reminded to meet with Thembi, the Head of Functions and Events, to obtain her input and recommendations before finalising the Great Hall booking process.